Supplementary Material

From Feedback to Revision: When Multi-Agent Roles Become Load-Bearing

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What this document is

The main paper states every claim it makes and is complete without this file. What it cannot carry, at eight pages, is the full numeric backing behind some of its sentences. That backing is here, each section reproducing the pointer the main text gives.

Every table below is **generated** by a script from hash-manifested data — the frozen snapshot, or the separately manifested feedback-matched runs; no number in a table is hand-typed. Each table carries its own provenance header in the source. The tables are reproduced here unchanged — same files, same bytes — so a number cannot drift between the paper and its supplement.

Reading the denominators. Two populations recur and are not interchangeable. The *marginal* population is every trajectory in a cell, with each condition on its own denominator. The *paired* population is only those problems first-pass wrong under *both* conditions, on one shared denominator; that is the actual test, and it is what every reported p-value is computed on (exact McNemar on discordant pairs). Where a table shows both, they are labeled and must not be read across. Conflating them has already produced one error in this project.

Recovery denominator. Throughout, recovery is conditioned on a recorded *first* evaluator verdict of incorrect — including trajectories that later died in regeneration, which score as failures under the pre-registered rule. Excluding those was a real defect in an earlier analysis and it moved results materially; it is noted here so a reader recomputing from the released data gets the same denominator.

1 The pre-registered endpoints in full

The main paper reports, in its Intervention section, that the pre-registered primary endpoint P4 — the actor × intervention interaction on accuracy — is null: none of the three pairwise difference-in-differences survives Holm, although before correction the Llama-3.3–gemma-4 interval narrowly excludes zero. It also reports that the P1a manipulation objective failed. Table 1 is the complete endpoint table promised there: all five endpoints as written before any intervention data existed, what each one returned, and the Holm-corrected verdict.

Two things in it deserve to be read rather than skimmed. First, only one of the three P4 contrasts is an *informative* null: the two involving Llama-3.3 cannot detect an interaction of any plausible size at their sample size, and are uninformative rather than evidence of absence. Second, the contrast this paper is organized around — role-structured versus role-free — was pre-registered as **secondary and exploratory**, and the feedback-matched role-free condition was not pre-registered at all. Both are labeled exploratory in the main paper and here.



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Table 1: Every pre-registered endpoint, and what became of it. Fixed in writing before any intervention data existed. P4 — the pre-registered primary test — is null, before and after the pre-registered Holm correction, and we report it as the failure of the thesis it was written to test. P1 failed *as written* and was re-designated rather than dropped: the interface forbids the planner emitting an *answer*, and nothing in it stops the planner *computing* — a dissociation we report as a finding. P2 and P5 are reported as effects and associations and carry no p-value, so the correctable family is P3's three contrasts and P4's three difference-in-differences. The MDE column is a detectability scale on a different population from the effect column — it is computed on problems shared by both actors, while each difference-in-difference uses each actor's own problem set; neither can be derived from the other.

endpoint	disposition
P1 intervention → fidelity (also the manipulation check)	**failed as written; re-designated.** The interface forbids an *answer* field, not computation. Re-scoped to answer authorship, which it drives to 0.000 in all three actors (Table 7). Reported as a second dissociation, not as a pass.
P2 actor × interv. on fidelity	not estimable across the panel: the fidelity clauses are condition-specific, so no common scale exists. Reported as unresolved rather than substituted.

P3 intervention → accuracy (enforced − role-structured), Holm across three:

	raw p	Holm p	verdict
gemma-4-31B	0.004	0.012	reject
gpt-oss-120b	0.582	0.789	retain
Llama-3.3-70B	0.394	0.789	retain

P4 actor × intervention on accuracy — *the pre-registered primary*, Holm across three:

	difference-in-diff. [CI]	raw p	Holm p	$\text{MDE}_{80\%}$	null is
gpt-oss-120b − gemma-4-31B	+0.0175 [-0.0050,+0.0406]	0.145	0.29	0.0325	informative
Llama-3.3-70B − gemma-4-31B	+0.0400 [+0.0006,+0.0800]	0.0553	0.166	0.0693	uninformative
Llama-3.3-70B − gpt-oss-120b	+0.0225 [-0.0181,+0.0631]	0.286	0.29	0.0748	uninformative

P5 Δfidelity vs Δoutcome	association only, pre-declared as non-causal: both sides are outcomes of the same intervention. No p-value is reported and none is corrected.

Only one of the three P4 nulls is informative. The largest per-actor main effect is small enough that a true interaction is plausibly ≤ 0.040; only the gpt-oss/gemma-4 contrast can see an effect that size. The two Llama-3.3 contrasts cannot detect an interaction of any plausible magnitude and are uninformative rather than evidence of absence.

2 First pass and recovery, both populations

Table 2 gives the frozen comparison between the role-structured team and the role-free team with the feedback withheld, in both populations, so that the marginal rates and the paired test can be checked against each other. (The feedback-matched comparison is in the main paper's Table 2.)

For gemma-4 the accounting closes exactly. Both conditions reach a correct first answer on 1,284 of 1,600 problems, and a correct first answer is never lost (the loop halts on a passing verdict), so the paired final-accuracy difference — $-54/1{,}600 = -0.0338$, exact McNemar $p = 1.6 \times 10^{-5}$, conditioned on nothing — equals the difference in recovery counts, 70 against 16. Stratified by the pair of first-pass outcomes, counting role-structured minus role-free final correct answers: the 1,205 problems both teams answer correctly first contribute 0; the 237 both miss contribute $38 - 4 = +34$ (discordant 37 versus 3); the 79 only the role-structured team misses contribute $32 - 79 = -47$; and the 79 only the role-free team misses contribute $79 - 12 = +67$. The last two strata condition on different problems, so their recovery rates (32/79 versus 12/79) are descriptive; together they contribute +20, in the same direction as the paired stratum. This accounting needs equal first-pass counts and does *not* transfer to the other two actors.

Table 2: First-pass accuracy and recovery, role-structured versus role-free. The two panels have different denominators and must not be read across. *Upper:* the marginal population — every trajectory in the cell, first pass over those receiving an evaluator verdict, recovery over those whose *first* verdict was incorrect (n_{fpw} in parentheses, computed per condition and therefore *not* a shared denominator). *Lower:* the paired population — only problems first-pass wrong under *both* conditions, one shared denominator n_{both}, which is the actual test. The recovery denominator counts every trajectory with a recorded incorrect first verdict, including those that later died in regeneration; these score 0 under the pre-registered rule. Pre-registered scoring throughout; p is exact McNemar on discordant pairs.

Marginal population — each condition on its own denominator

	first pass			recovery | first verdict wrong		
actor	role-struct.	role-free	difference	role-struct. (n)	role-free (n)	difference
gemma-4-31B	0.802	0.802	+0.0000 [−0.0156, +0.0150]	0.222 (316)	0.051 (316)	−0.1709 [−0.2247, −0.1171]
gpt-oss-120b	0.713	0.763	+0.0503 [+0.0339, +0.0666]	0.324 (463)	0.247 (380)	−0.0766 [−0.1361, −0.0153]
Llama-3.3-70B	0.308	0.316	+0.0077 [−0.0283, +0.0437]	0.014 (276)	0.015 (268)	+0.0004 [−0.0214, +0.0192]

Paired population — problems first-pass wrong under **both** conditions; one shared denominator

actor	n_{both}	role-struct.	role-free	role-struct. only	role-free only	exact p
gemma-4-31B	237	0.160	0.017	37	3	1.95×10^{-8}
gpt-oss-120b	327	0.242	0.202	52	39	0.208
Llama-3.3-70B	245	0.004	0.016	1	4	0.375

Recovery conditions on a post-treatment variable and is descriptive, never causal. No cell recovers before its first oracle verdict.

3 Cross-domain replication

Table 3 is the SciBench replication in full. The main paper carries both actors in Figure 1 and Table 2; this is the frozen comparison with its denominators.

The domain contract is *not* byte-identical to Omni-MATH, and the released prompt files make the difference checkable: of the 16 prompts the two domains share, 11 are byte-identical and 5 differ. The five are the four role-structured Planner/Executor/Reviewer prompts and the **evaluator** prompt, which must ask for scientific rather than mathematical equivalence. **All four role-free prompts are byte-identical across domains**, as are all six structurally enforced ones.

That asymmetry is worth stating plainly rather than leaving to a diff: the role-structured prompts, whose team recovers less, are the ones that were rewritten, and the role-free prompts ran identical text in both domains. The rewrite is domain wording — "algebraic manipulation or numerical calculation" where Omni-MATH said "symbolic manipulation or arithmetic" — and the structural clauses are unchanged. A reader who suspects the adaptation is doing the work can check the released files; that is why they are released.

Topology, budget, decoding, retry policy and the evaluator protocol are unchanged. This is a replication of the *mechanism* under a matched protocol, not a rerun of identical prompts.

Table 3: The dissociation replicates out of domain. SciBench, the complete 574-problem matched slice of free-response college science; two actors, 2296 trajectories, frozen separately from the Omni-MATH snapshot. The two panels have different populations. First pass is paired over all 574 problems; paired recovery is over only those first-pass wrong under *both* conditions (n_{both}), which is why its n is roughly a sixth the size. Pre-registered scoring; p is exact McNemar on discordant pairs. gpt-oss's recovery cell cannot resolve its own effect at the realized n_{both} — its point estimate is in the same direction and nearly the same size as Omni-MATH's, so it is underpowered rather than a non-replication. Llama-3.3 was not run in this domain.

	first pass (paired, all problems)					recovery (paired on first-pass wrong under both)						
actor	n	role-str.	role-free	diff.	exact p	n_{both}	role-str.	role-free	diff.	r-s. only	r-f. only	exact p
gemma-4-31B	574	0.794	0.794	+0.0000	1	99	0.212	0.020	−0.1919	21	2	6.60×10^{-5}
gpt-oss-120b	574	0.784	0.789	+0.0052	0.784	96	0.219	0.135	−0.0833	17	9	0.169

4 The feedback-matched control, run twice

The two gemma-4 cells of the feedback-matched role-free condition were run twice, independently, about thirteen hours apart, with byte-identical runner and prompt code; every other feedback-matched cell was run once. Each run also repeated the drift check of the main text on the same 400 frozen problems: the role-structured re-run reaches final accuracy 0.818 in the first and 0.845 in the second, against 0.825 frozen (paired $p = 0.75$ and $p = 0.20$). The main text reports the first run throughout. Table 4 gives both against the frozen role-structured cell. The ordering and the final-accuracy contrasts reproduce in both domains; the SciBench paired recovery test, on 100 problems, is $p = 0.013$ in the first run and $p = 0.052$ in the second.

5 Where the role-structured Reviewer declines

The main paper's account of what roles do after feedback — a gate on submission — rests on Table 5, computed from the logged route of every Reviewer turn. A cycle ends in an approval (a submission) or a decline. Declines are split by when they happen: before the first submission, when no feedback exists; in a cycle that received a FAIL, the only cycle the role-structured clause covers; and in later cycles in which no clause forbids approval. Trajectories that never approve in six cycles are graded once at the end and never receive feedback; they count as first-pass wrong and unrecovered, as the pre-registered scoring requires.

On Omni-MATH the clause covers a minority of the declines of the role-structured Reviewer, and in the free cycles it approves far less often than the role-free team's third agent; gpt-oss is the closest of the three. On SciBench the clause covers more. With at most one round of feedback the role-free team recovers as much or more in every cell. Recoveries per verdict after the first are higher with roles in every cell, but that ratio compares different trajectories: most of the role-free team's later verdicts are further attempts on problems it has already failed more than once. The like-for-like comparison is the verdict-matched one in the main paper (Table 2): on the problems both teams first answer wrongly, with each role-free trajectory cut off after as many verdicts as the role-structured team received on the same problem, the two recover equally in all five cells.

6 Removing the submission gate

The forced-submission run tests the gate directly. It uses the role-structured prompts and runner unchanged except for one step: after the Reviewer's turn, the pipeline submits the team's current answer to the evaluator whatever route the Reviewer chose, and the verdict and hint reach the agents through the same role-specific slots as in the role-structured condition. The offline test `test_afs.py` (supplementary material) checks that the prompts are byte-identical to the role-structured ones up to the first verdict and that the evaluator is called in every cycle. It was run once, after the freeze, for gemma-4 on the 400 Omni-MATH problems of the role-structured re-run, with the same endpoint, budget and evaluator. Table 6 compares it with that re-run, the frozen role-structured cell and the role-free team with feedback, restricted to the same problems. Recovery rises to the role-free team's level while first-pass accuracy does not move; the Reviewer's logged approvals no longer decide anything.

7 Validation of the measures

Definitions were frozen before the adjudication sheet was opened; 72 Planner messages (P1a) and 13 Executor messages (plan adherence) were adjudicated by hand, each with a recorded reason. P1a agrees with the hand labels on 0.903 of messages (Cohen's $\kappa = 0.806$; precision 0.943, recall 0.868); Executor plan adherence on 0.923 ($\kappa = 0.843$), at a sample too small for a narrow interval. Both clear the pre-set 0.80 threshold. P1a agreement fell from 0.967 at $n = 30$ as adjudication continued; we report the final figure. Its residual errors point in opposite directions — symbolic results with no digits are missed, restated givens are flagged — so they do not bias the actor comparison.

8 An early campaign stopped for a truncation confound

The main run was gated on a smoke test requiring non-zero boundary rejections with reasons logged, answer-bearing calls equal across conditions, and a pinned backend. An early campaign was stopped after 121 trajectories when 74% of enforcement rejections proved to be the model cut off at the token limit mid-JSON rather than violating a role boundary. Truncation was not condition-specific but its *cost* was — a prose condition tolerates a truncated message where the enforced one rejects unparseable JSON — so left alone it would have produced a convincing "enforcement lowers accuracy" artifact. The limit was doubled and the pre-fix rows were never pooled.

9 Structural enforcement: both scorings, and the attrition that separates them

The main paper reports that enforcement loosens the submission gate in all three actors (and un-freezes the answer for gemma-4 and Llama-3.3) but does not become end-to-end accuracy, and that the apparent accuracy benefit is survivorship. Table 7 is the evidence for both halves: the manipulation check, the one-sided attrition, and the same accuracy column under both scorings with intervals.

This is the table behind the sentence in the main text that the enforced recovery and first-pass rates **do not compose** into the accuracy column. They cannot: trajectories that never finish are never graded, so the three quantities do not share a denominator and the $(1 - \text{first-pass}) \times \text{recovery}$ identity does not hold. The pre-registration fixed in advance that unparseable trajectories count as incorrect rather than being dropped, and that rule is what makes the as-graded reading survivorship rather than a finding.

Table 4: The gemma-4 feedback-matched cells, run twice. Both runs use byte-identical runner and prompt code; the main text reports run 1. Paired columns count problems recovered (or finally correct) only without roles versus only with them, on problems first-pass wrong under both conditions (recovery) or on all problems (final), with exact McNemar p.

	first pass	recovery	paired recovery	final	paired final
Omni-MATH					
role-structured (frozen)	0.802	70/316 = 0.222	–	0.846	–
role-free + feedback, run 1	0.802	193/317 = 0.609	89 vs 4, $p = 6.2 \times 10^{-22}$	0.921	137 vs 17, $p = 1.7 \times 10^{-24}$
role-free + feedback, run 2	0.811	177/302 = 0.586	95 vs 7, $p = 7.8 \times 10^{-21}$	0.922	139 vs 18, $p = 2.4 \times 10^{-24}$
SciBench					
role-structured (frozen)	0.794	30/118 = 0.254	–	0.847	–
role-free + feedback, run 1	0.796	49/117 = 0.419	21 vs 7, $p = 0.013$	0.880	31 vs 12, $p = 0.0054$
role-free + feedback, run 2	0.784	54/124 = 0.435	19 vs 8, $p = 0.052$	0.878	29 vs 11, $p = 0.0064$

Table 5: Where the role-structured Reviewer declines, and what each allocation buys. First-pass-wrong trajectories. Declining cycles per trajectory, split into those before the first submission (no feedback yet), those that received a FAIL (where the role-structured clause forbids approval) and later "free" cycles; the clause share is the second as a fraction of all three. "Never submits": trajectories with no approval in six cycles, graded once at the end. Free-cycle approval: share of free cycles ending in approval, role-structured (RS) against role-free with feedback (RF). Recovered by the second verdict: with at most one round of feedback, over all first-pass-wrong trajectories. Per later verdict: recoveries per verdict after the first, a ratio over different trajectories in the two conditions (the verdict-matched comparison of the main paper's Table 2 is the like-for-like one). Approvals: submissions per trajectory.

	RS declining cycles			clause	RS never	free-cycle approval		by 2nd verdict		per later verdict		approvals	
actor, domain	before	FAIL	free	share	submits	RS	RF	RS	RF	RS	RF	RS	RF
gemma-4, Omni-MATH	2.24	0.81	1.20	0.19	84/316	0.25	0.96	0.206	0.438	0.41	0.28	1.27	3.20
gpt-oss, Omni-MATH	1.33	1.17	0.71	0.37	51/463	0.53	0.68	0.246	0.296	0.27	0.22	2.10	3.53
Llama-3.3, Omni-MATH	4.49	0.25	0.88	0.04	205/276	0.01	0.82	0.014	0.092	0.25	0.08	0.32	2.71
gemma-4, SciBench	0.55	1.38	1.48	0.40	3/118	0.35	0.99	0.237	0.239	0.26	0.16	1.95	3.62
gpt-oss, SciBench	0.41	1.53	0.60	0.60	1/124	0.67	0.78	0.258	0.317	0.19	0.16	2.68	3.95

Table 6: Removing the submission gate. gemma-4, Omni-MATH, the same 400 problems in every row. The forced-submission run uses the role-structured prompts byte for byte; the pipeline submits the team's answer to the evaluator in every cycle, whatever the Reviewer decides. Recovery is over each row's own first-pass-wrong trajectories; verdicts and Reviewer approvals are per first-pass-wrong trajectory and include the first. In the forced-submission run approvals are logged but do not decide submission. The lower block pairs the conditions on the problems both first answer wrongly (recovery) and on all problems (final accuracy): problems solved only by the first condition / only by the second, exact McNemar p.

condition	first pass	recovery	final accuracy	verdicts	Reviewer approvals
role-structured, every cycle submitted	0.767	57/93 = 0.613	0.910	4.20	0.98
role-structured, re-run after the freeze	0.772	18/91 = 0.198	0.818	1.44	1.13
role-structured, frozen snapshot	0.795	12/82 = 0.146	0.825	1.41	1.15
role-free with feedback	0.795	45/82 = 0.549	0.907	3.34	3.34

		recovery (both first wrong)		final accuracy	
pair	n	first / second only	p	first / second only	p
every cycle submitted vs. re-run	72	26 / 2	3.0×10^{-6}	42 / 5	2.5×10^{-8}
every cycle submitted vs. role-free with feedback	70	7 / 7	1	8 / 7	1
re-run vs. role-free with feedback	65	3 / 22	1.6×10^{-4}	6 / 42	1.0×10^{-7}

Table 7: Structural enforcement. Enforcing the division of labor at the interface. *Manipulation check:* the rate at which the planner authors an answer, under enforcement and (in parentheses) when roles are merely deleted — enforcement drives it to zero in all three actors, so the intervention engaged. *Frozen answer:* the team never changed its answer string, among first-pass-wrong trajectories (role-free/role-structured in parentheses). *Recovery:* role-structured in parentheses, on the denominator of Table 2. The two accuracy columns are different populations, and the attrition column is why they disagree. The pre-registered rule scores never-graded trajectories incorrect; the as-graded column drops them and is a *sensitivity analysis only* — its gains are conditional on parsing successfully, and enforcement is the only condition where that removes a material fraction of the data. Enforcement restores recovery for Llama-3.3; for the other two actors the direction is consistent but not resolvable against that attrition.

	planner authors	frozen answer	recovery		final accuracy, enforced − role-structured	
actor	answer (role-free) manipulation check	(r-f./r-s.) first-pass wrong	(role-str.) first-pass wrong	attrition	pre-registered (primary)	as-graded (sensitivity)
gemma-4-31B	0.000 (0.986)	0.119 (0.845/0.288)	0.314 (0.222)	8.0%	−0.0225 [-0.0387,-0.0063]	+0.0190 [+0.0054,+0.0333]
gpt-oss-120b	0.000 (0.916)	0.092 (0.208/0.052)	0.395 (0.324)	9.9%	−0.0050 [-0.0219,+0.0112]	+0.0361 [+0.0215,+0.0507]
Llama-3.3-70B	0.000 (0.958)	0.072 (0.806/0.750)	0.139 (0.014)	17.0%	+0.0175 [-0.0200,+0.0550]	+0.0453 [+0.0030,+0.0876]

Attrition elsewhere is negligible: 0.0–0.7% with roles, 0.0–2.5% with roles removed. The as-graded column turns every sign positive; the pre-registration fixed in advance that unparseable trajectories count incorrect, and **the benefit appears only after conditioning on successful parsing.**

10 The single-agent comparator

Table 8 is the budget-matched single-agent reference. The main paper uses it in one direction only — as a guard against reading "collapse costs nothing" as "the system was one agent all along" — and this table is why that restraint is necessary.

Table 8: Against a budget-matched single agent. Both directions, which must be read together. A collapsed gpt-oss team beats its own single agent, so three agents emitting one answer is not functionally one agent; but gemma-4's team is worse than its own single agent in both conditions — and gemma-4 carries the recovery result. Provenance: this panel is not from the frozen snapshot; it comes from a previously released trace corpus, joined by problem. Its two actor arms were produced in separate runs, so each direction is a sound directional guard while *the gap between actors is not* — no statement about relative magnitude across actors is supported here. The comparison is conservative on the decisive axis: the single agent draws *more* oracle feedback and about half the actor calls.

organization	team	single agent	difference
gemma-4-31B			
role-structured	0.8462	0.8688	−0.0225
	$[-0.0400, -0.0056]$, $p = 0.0122$, $n = 1600$		
role-free	0.8125	0.8688	−0.0563
	$[-0.0737, -0.0394]$, $p = 1.22 \times 10^{-10}$, $n = 1600$		
gpt-oss-120b			
role-structured	0.8031	0.7900	+0.0131
	$[-0.0044, +0.0300]$, $p = 0.152$, $n = 1600$		
role-free	0.8194	0.7900	+0.0294
	$[+0.0125, +0.0456]$, $p = 0.000678$, $n = 1600$		

Realized call budget

actor	protocol	evaluator	actor
gemma-4-31B	single agent	1.66	3.16
gemma-4-31B	role-structured team	1.11	6.76
gemma-4-31B	role-free team	1.95	5.87
gpt-oss-120b	single agent	1.69	3.40
gpt-oss-120b	role-structured team	1.35	7.54
gpt-oss-120b	role-free team	1.85	6.25

The comparator comes from a **previously released corpus whose two actor arms were produced in separate runs**. Each direction within an actor is therefore a sound guard, and *the gap between actors is not.* The result cuts both ways: a collapsed gpt-oss team beats its own single agent, while gemma-4's is significantly worse in both conditions. Neither "multi-agent systems are just single agents" nor "more agents help" survives contact with it.

Table 9: Recovery by pooled accumulated-context quartile (supplement; the panel behind the context caveat in R2). Denominator is the first-pass-wrong population. Context is the total character count of all planner, executor and reviewer messages in the trajectory; quartile cut points are computed *once per actor over both conditions pooled*. This is directional only. Accumulated context is nearly a function of condition — the role-free team talks less because it stops reworking — so the strata are not balanced and this comparison cannot separate context from condition. It is reported because it is the obvious competing explanation and because it does not behave uniformly: the gap survives in the lower quartiles, but in gpt-oss's top quartile the ordering reverses.

	role-structured		role-free		
context quartile	recovery	*n*	recovery	*n*	difference
gemma-4-31B					
Q1 (least context)	0.662	65	0.151	93	+0.511
Q2	0.280	50	0.009	108	+0.271
Q3	0.047	85	0.014	73	+0.033
Q4 (most)	0.078	116	0.000	42	+0.078
gpt-oss-120b					
Q1 (least context)	0.923	13	0.258	198	+0.665
Q2	0.656	128	0.293	82	+0.363
Q3	0.262	164	0.191	47	+0.071
Q4 (most)	0.070	158	0.189	53	−0.119
Llama-3.3-70B					
Q1 (least context)	0.100	40	0.031	96	+0.069
Q2	0.000	86	0.000	50	+0.000
Q3	0.000	103	0.030	33	−0.030
Q4 (most)	0.000	47	0.000	89	+0.000

11 Accumulated context as a competing explanation

Accumulated context is the obvious competing cause of recovery failure, and Table 9 is the full panel promised in the main text.

It is reported with a caveat that is not decoration. Quartile cut points are computed over both conditions *pooled*, and accumulated context is nearly a function of condition — the role-free team accumulates less because it stops reworking. The strata are therefore not balanced, and this comparison cannot separate context from condition. It is **directional only**, and it is included because it does not behave uniformly: the gap survives in the lower quartiles, but in gpt-oss's top quartile the ordering reverses. A stratification that had come out cleanly everywhere would have been weaker evidence, not stronger, because it could not have failed.

12 AI assistance

Reproduced in full here rather than pointed at. AAMAS requires that supplementary material ship inside the submission, and a disclosure a reviewer cannot open is not a disclosure.

AAMAS asks that where AI-assisted technologies contribute to hypotheses, methodology or experimental design, authors disclose the tool, version and role. This work used them substantially in all three, so what follows is detailed rather than pro forma.

Tools. A large language model agent (Anthropic Claude, Opus-class) performed research execution: experiment implementation, campaign operation, analysis scripting, manuscript drafting and internal review. Exact build identifiers were not retained for every session. A frontier model was additionally used as a *measurement instrument* for the rubric-based adjudication of whether a division of labor was realized; that model and rubric version are recorded in the released artifact. The actor models under study are the experimental subjects, not assistance, and are named in the paper.

What the agents did. The hypotheses tested here — whether role organization contributes to first-pass generation and to post-failure revision, and through which channel — were formed by agents from observed results and then subjected to pre-registered and exploratory tests. An earlier hypothesis was falsified by the agents' own analysis and retracted; this paper reports that null. Condition design, budget matching, the pre-registration and the stopping and exclusion rules were drafted by agents under human direction and frozen before confirmatory analysis. Agents wrote the runner, operated and froze the campaign, wrote all analysis code, drafted and revised the manuscript, and conducted several independent internal reviews — including blind reviews given only the compiled PDF, and adversarial audits tasked with invalidating the paper's own claims. Every manuscript number is generated by a canonical script from a hash-manifested frozen snapshot; no numeric literal is hand-maintained.

What the human author directed and approved. Research direction and every pivot; the decision to pre-register and the pre-declared not-submit conditions; the choice of actor models and domains; the decision to use model adjudication in place of human annotation, with the instruction not to overstate what it establishes; the instruction that the page limit may not be met by hiding caveats; and final approval of all claims. The scope limits — not overstating actor generality, not publishing the data during review — were human decisions.

Prompts, and what was not retained. The exact role prompts, schemas and evaluator prompt are released in the artifact as experimental material. Session prompts directing the agents' research work were **not retained verbatim**, and we do not reconstruct prompts that were not kept; standing instructions are reconstructed in the project record from the decision log. Model build identifiers were not retained for every session. Everything load-bearing for a reported number — experimental prompts, schemas, configurations, budgets, and the frozen rows themselves — is retained and released.

Errors this process found in its own work. Agent review found several defects in the agents' own instrumentation and analysis. Each is disclosed in the paper rather than silently repaired: a logging defect that left one actor's planner output uninstrumented; a scoring defect that inflates this paper's main contrast, reported with its correction; a recovery denominator that excluded valid trajectories, whose repair moved results materially; and a blinding leak in the adjudication, which is why this paper does not describe its condition-contrastive adjudication as blinded.